

Department of Economics
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EDUCATION

- 2014–2020 Ph.D. in Economics, Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU), New Delhi
Dissertation: *Intergenerational Economic Mobility in India: During 1945–1990*
Supervisor: Prof. Praveen Jha
- 2005–2007 M.A. in Economics, Gokhale Institute of Economics & Politics (GIPE), Pune
- 2002–2005 B.A. in Economics, Rajaram College, Shivaji University, Kolhapur

EMPLOYMENT & AFFILIATIONS

- 2022– Assistant Professor, FLAME University, Pune
- 2020–2022 Assistant Professor, Christ University-Lavasa
- 2018–2020 Senior Consultant, Indian Institute for Human Settlements (IIHS), Bangalore
- 2009–2014 Research Associate, Institute of Rural Management Anand (IRMA), Anand
- 2008–2009 Research Assistant, CUTS International, Jaipur

RESEARCH FIELDS

- Primary: Development Economics, Labour Markets & Inequality, Caste and Social Stratification
- Secondary: Education–Occupation Mismatch, Vulnerability & Informal Employment, Platform/Gig Work

PUBLISHED & FORTHCOMING PAPERS

- 2025 “Gender Differences in Returns to Education Mismatch” (Unni, J.; Naik, R.), in *Women and Work: Challenges, Opportunities and Perspectives for Policy*, Springer Nature (Forthcoming).
- 2024 “Heterogeneity of Labour on Digital Platforms in India” (Unni, J.; Naik, R.), *Economic & Political Weekly*.
- 2022 “Gender Differentials in Entrepreneurship: Insights from a Multi-method Study” (Unni, J.; Yadav, V.; Naik, R.; Datta, S.), *The Journal of Entrepreneurship*, 31(1): 30–64.

- 2021 “Women Entrepreneurs In The New Indian Middle Class: Macro & Micro Perspectives” (Unni, J.; Yadav, V.; Naik, R.; Datta, S.), Orient Blackswan, ISBN: 9789354421457.
- 2013 “Employment Vulnerability in the Urban Labour Market in India” (Naik, R.; Unni, J.), *The Indian Journal of Labour Economics*, 56(4): 509–523.
- 2013 “Measuring Informality of Employment in Urban India” (Unni, J.; Naik, R.), *The Indian Journal of Labour Economics*, 56(4): 493–508.
- 2009 “Rural Structural Transformation: Case of the Service Sector in India” (Unni, J.; Naik, R.), *Economic & Political Weekly*, 46(26–27).

SUBMITTED / UNDER REVIEW

- 2026 “Stratified Modernisation: Caste, Gender, and Occupational Prestige in Urban India” (Naik, R.; Ravindra, S.).
- 2026 “Beyond Binary Access: Multidimensional Digital Deprivation and Caste in India” (Naik, R.).
- 2026 “Angry Enough to Redistribute? Beliefs and the Inequality–Redistribution Gap” (Naik, R.).
- 2026 “Rule Design and Competitive Balance in T20 Cricket: Evidence from the IPL Impact Player Rule and the BBL Power Surge” (Naik, R.; Ramchandani, S.).
- 2026 “Stepping Stone or Trap? Educational Mismatch and Occupational Mobility in Urban India” (Naik, R.; Unni, J.).
- 2025 “Fighting the Double-Edged Sword: Innovation and Internationalisation of Emerging-Market Firms” (Sayyad, A.A.; Naik, R.).

WORKING PAPERS

- 2026 “Institutional Design and Quality Definitions in Indian Cinema: Evidence from Four Award Systems” (Naik, R.).
- 2026 “Beyond Education: What Explains Intergenerational Income Persistence in India?” (Naik, R.).
- 2026 “Outflanked by Privatization: How Caste Advantage Evades Affirmative Action in India” (Naik, R.).
- 2026 “Economic Inequality, Institutional Trust, and Political Participation in India: Evidence from the India Human Development Survey” (Naik, R.).
- 2025 “Canaries in the Code? AI Exposure and Employment in India” (Naik, R.).
- 2025 “Inter-generational Persistence and Role of Assortative Marriages in India” (Naik, R.).
- 2025 “The Double Penalty: Education-Occupation Mismatch and Wage Returns in India’s Formal and Informal Labour Markets” (Naik, R.; Unni, J.).

WORKS IN PROGRESS

- 2026 “Is the Overeducation Wage Penalty a Worker Effect, a Firm Effect, or a Sorting Effect?” (Naik, R.)
- 2026 “Same Degree, Different Jobs: Caste, Class, and Education-Occupation Mismatch in India

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2025 “Unleashing India’s Hustle: Role of Caste and Gender in the Performance of Informal Enterprises,” 3rd Global Conference on Caste, Business and Society, Saïd Business School, Oxford, July 21–23.
- 2025 “Platform Workers and Wage Determination in India’s Gig Economy,” 61st Annual Indian Society of Labour Economics Conference.
- 2019 “Dualistic Structure of Industry and Growth of Firms,” 28th IAFPE Annual Conference, Glasgow Caledonian University, June 27–29.
- 2019 “Puzzle of Low Return Entrepreneurship and Small Business in India,” 60th Annual ISLE Conference, IGIDR, Mumbai, December 17–18.
- 2016 “Educational Mismatch, Informality and Returns to Education in India,” 58th Annual ISLE Conference, IIT Guwahati, November 23–25.
- 2015 “Educational Expansion and Social Mobility in India: Origin, Education and Destination,” International Conference on “(Persistent) Inequalities Revisited,” Monte Verità, Switzerland, July 26–31.

GRANTS & FUNDING

- 2024 Digital Labour Platforms in India: Understanding Precarity and Empowerment, Indian Council of Social Science Research (ICSSR). Role: Co-Project Director.
- 2017 IDRC-Think Tank Initiative Grant, International Development Research Centre (IDRC). Role: Research Associate.

RESEARCH PROJECTS

- 2022– Platform Workers in India: Wages, Skills, and Working Conditions. Primary survey of 2,000+ workers across Ahmedabad and Pune. Role: Co-Project Director.
- 2018–2019 Mapping Bangalore’s Industrial Transformation, IIHS. Role: Research Associate.
- 2015–2017 Women Entrepreneurs in the New Indian Middle Class, IRMA. Role: Research Associate and Co-coordinator.

2017–2021 **IDRC-Think Tank Initiative Project**, IRMA. Role: Research Associate.
2009–2016 **Informality, Poverty and Growth in India-China**, IRMA. Role: Research Assistant.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

FLAME **Labor Economics, Macroeconomics, Gender Economics, Public Economics** (UG), 2022–
Christ **Labor Economics, Econometrics** (Graduate); **Microeconomics, Law & Economics, Public Economics** (UG), 2020–2022

SKILLS

Coding Stata (Advanced), Python (Intermediate), Julia (Familiar), $\text{\LaTeX}$, GitHub
Methods: Panel data estimation, DID, IV, DML, Causal forests, Survey design
Data: PLFS, IHDS, NLSY79, Primary surveys
Languages: English (Fluent), Hindi (Native), German (Beginner), Russian (Basic)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee: *Economic & Political Weekly*, *Indian Journal of Labour Economics* (SAGE),
Humanities and Social Science Communications (Springer Nature)
Member: **Indian Society of Labour Economics (ISLE)**, **European Association of Labour Economics (EALE)**, **International Association for Feminist Economics (IAFFE)**, **American Association of Geographers (AAG)**

REFERENCES

Dr. Uma Rani, Senior Economist, International Labour Organisation (ILO), Geneva, Switzerland. Email: amara@ilo.org
Prof. Praveen Jha (PhD Supervisor), Centre for Informal Sector & Labour Studies, Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi. Email: praveen@jnu.ac.in
Prof. Jeemol Unni, Amrut Mody School of Management, Ahmedabad University. Email: jeemol@gmail.com